FOR PARENTS · SUPPORTING YOUR YOUNG PLAYER

MANAGING YOUR OWN EMOTIONS

When you care a lot, too

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THE QUICK VERSION

> Watching your child play can bring out big emotions: pride, nerves, frustration, even anger. That's completely normal, because you love them. But your child feels your emotions as well as their own. Learning to manage yours is one of the best gifts you can give them.

WHAT'S REALLY GOING ON

Kids constantly read the faces, body language and tone of their parents. If you look stressed on the sideline or quiet and tense in the car, they often assume it's about them. Staying calm, even when you're disappointed or worried, shows them how to handle tough moments with grace.

KNOW YOUR TRIGGERS

BEFORE GAMES

- Worrying about selection
- Nerves for your child
- Comparing with other families

DURING GAMES

- Refereeing decisions
- Your child's mistakes
- How other parents behave

AFTER GAMES

- Disappointment with the result
- Frustration with the coach
- Feeling your child didn't try

Check yourself before the car ride home

Take a deep breath, a few minutes, or a short walk before you talk. Ask yourself: "Is what I'm about to say for me, or for my child?" If it's for you, save it for another adult.

TRY THIS

1. **Breathe before you react**
   Three slow breaths can stop a comment you'd regret.
2. **Have a sideline buddy**
   Stand with a calm parent who helps you stay level.
3. **Remember the big picture**
   One game, one decision, one mistake won't define their journey.
4. **Vent to adults, not kids**
   Share frustrations with your partner or friend, away from your child.
5. **Repair if you slip**
   If you overreact, apologise. It teaches your child how to own mistakes.

SAY THIS, NOT THAT

SAY THIS	NOT THAT
"I was a bit stressed today. That's on me, not you."	~~"You made me so stressed watching that."~~
"I loved watching you play."	~~(Silence and a tense face in the car)~~
"Let's both take a breather."	~~"I can't believe you did that!"~~

QUICK SELF-CHECK

- [ ] I know what triggers my emotions at games
- [ ] I wait before talking after a tough game
- [ ] I vent to adults, not my child
- [ ] I apologise if I overreact

Can't tick them all yet? That's normal. Pick one to work on this week.

COACH'S CORNER

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Players can always tell what their parents are feeling. A calm, proud face in the crowd is worth more than any pep talk.

THE FUTURE BALLER TEAM